SOFTWARE ENGINEERING PROJECT

MILESTONE 1 REPORT

Student Mentoring and Career Support Platform

Team 032 – Himalayan Coders
IIT Madras | Problem Statement 2 | September 2026

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1. Problem Context and Purpose

Students in the IITM BS Degree Program may require career guidance while exploring skill development, career transitions, résumé and interview preparation, and other professional goals. However, finding a suitable mentor can be challenging when students lack an effective way to compare mentors' expertise, availability, and the relevance of their professional experience.

The proposed **Student Mentoring and Career Support Platform** aims to address these challenges by enabling students to describe their mentoring needs, discover suitable mentors, submit mentoring requests, coordinate sessions, and provide feedback. Mentors will be able to showcase their professional experience, specify their availability, and manage incoming mentoring requests. Program administrators will be able to verify mentor profiles, follow up on delayed requests, and review program-level participation.

Evidence Status: This report is based on the Milestone 1 PDF supplied and survey responses from students and mentors. Student and mentor user stories are linked to survey evidence, while administrator user stories are based on discussions with the client, IIC.

2. Users Identified

2.1 Primary users

Current IITM BS students

- Students at Degree levels who need guidance on skill enhancement, career switching, resume/interview preparation, or related goals.
- Students who want to describe their needs, search for mentors, review credentials and availability, send requests, and attend mentoring sessions.

Mentors

- Recent graduates and IITM alumni are willing to share experience and provide career or skill guidance.
- Mentors who create profiles, identify areas of expertise and availability, accept or reject requests, and conduct sessions.

2.2 Secondary users

Operational users – Program administrators / IIC team

- Administrators who may verify mentor profiles, monitor matching and delayed requests, resolve stuck cases, and review participation and effectiveness.

2.3 Tertiary users

- Employers and industry contacts, faculty, teaching assistants, the IITM BS Programme office, students' families, and hosting/communication providers. These stakeholders may be affected by the platform but are not necessarily direct users.

3. User Research and Findings

3.1 Mentorship Needs Survey

A Google Form survey was conducted to understand students' mentorship needs, preferred communication methods, mentoring duration, and challenges in finding suitable mentors. The survey received responses: twelve students, three mentors. And seven client/administrator responses were prepared from the IIC G-Meet. The findings are preliminary and have been considered alongside the client's stated requirements while defining the user stories.

3.2 User Stories and Research Findings

The following table maps all 21 user stories, including eleven student-focused stories, to the relevant research findings or client requirements and the corresponding proposed platform features. Survey-derived observations are distinguished from requirements specified by the client.

No.	User Story ID	User / Role	User Story / Requirement	Research Finding or Client Requirement	Proposed Platform Feature
1	US-S01	Student	Register and create a student profile.	Students have different mentoring needs and require a structured way to provide their information.	Student registration and profile creation.
2	US-M01	Mentor	Register and create a mentor profile.	Structured mentor information is needed to support client-led matching.	Mentor registration and profile creation.
3	US-C01	Client/Administrator	Access student and mentor profiles to assess suitability for matching.	The client specified that only authorised personnel should access both profile types for matching.	Authorised client access to student and mentor profiles.

4	US-C02	Client/Administrator	Match students with suitable mentors based on student requirements and mentor expertise.	Client meeting responses mention matching difficulties; the client requires matching to be managed centrally.	Client-mediated mentorship matching.
5	US-C03	Client/Administrator	Record a mentorship connection and notify relevant participants.	A structured record is needed to document the match and communicate the outcome.	Match records and proposed notifications; notification method requires confirmation.
6	US-C04	Client/Administrator	Manage the status of mentorship connections.	Tracking connections can help the client follow up on ongoing or incomplete matches	Mentorship-status management.
7	US-S02	Student	Update the student profile and mentoring needs.	Students seek support for skill enhancement, career switching, and resume/interview preparation.	Student profile editing and mentoring needs updates.
8	US-C05	Client/Administrator	Maintain mentor expertise and availability information.	Students highlighted mentor skills and credentials; availability can support suitable matching.	Management of mentor expertise and availability information.
9	US-C06	Client/Administrator	Protect student and mentor profile confidentiality through role-based access.	The client specified that users must not browse other users' profiles without authorisation.	Role-based access control and profile confidentiality.
10	US-C07	Client/Administrator	View a matching overview and identify follow-up needs.	The client needs visibility into mentorship connections and cases requiring attention.	Matching overview and follow-up dashboard.

11	US-M02	Mentor	Update and edit my mentor profile, including my professional background, qualifications, skills, experience, and areas of expertise.	Accurate and up-to-date mentor profile information helps the client assess mentor suitability and make appropriate mentoring matches.	Mentor profile editing and updating functionality.
12	US-M03	Mentor	Maintain mentorship availability and respond to client contact.	Availability and communication are relevant to coordinating client-mediated matches.	Availability updates and a proposed process for responding to client contact.
13	US-S03	Student	Define mentoring goals and desired outcomes.	Students reported different guidance needs; structured goals support relevant matching.	Student goal/outcome
14	US-S04	Student	Specify the subject, skill, or career area for guidance.	Topic-specific guidance and mentor expertise were raised in responses.	Student expertise-area preferences.
15	US-S05	Student	Choose preferred interaction format and duration.	Responses included video, phone/messaging, and varied durations.	Interaction and duration preferences.
16	US-S06	Student	Share general availability for mentorship.	Flexible timing was raised; detailed scheduling rules need confirmation.	Availability fields.
17	US-S07	Student	Review a mentorship connection assigned by the client.	The client controls matching; students do not browse mentor profiles.	Private assigned-connection view.
18	US-S08	Student	Confirm readiness for an assigned connection, if approved.	A student response step may support coordination but needs client validation.	Optional readiness response.
19	US-S09	Student	Request client review if an assigned connection is unsuitable.	Matching difficulties were reported; rematch process needs validation.	Concern/request-for-review workflow.

20	US-S10	Student	Provide feedback on a mentorship experience.	Feedback could help assess usefulness; details need client approval.	Private feedback form.
21	US-S11	Student	See status and next steps for an assigned connection.	Status tracking exists in the client workflow; students need clear next steps.	Student-facing status view.

3.3 Pain Points and Corresponding User Stories

The following table connects the identified pain points to the user stories that address them and explains how the proposed platform is intended to respond.

Identified Pain Point	Relevant User Stories	How the Platform Addresses It
Difficulty finding a suitable mentor	US-C04, US-S03, US-S04, US-S07, US-S09	The authorised client/administrator reviews student needs and mentor expertise to make suitable matches.
Lack of structured student and mentor information	US-C01, US-C02, US-C07, US-C08, US-M1, US-S03, US-S04, US-S05, US-S06	Users create and maintain profiles containing relevant information.
Difficulty assessing mentor suitability	US-C03, US-C04, US-C08, US-M1, US-S03, US-S04, US-S05	The client reviews mentor expertise and student requirements before matching.
Coordination of mentor availability	US-C08, US-M2	Mentor availability can be maintained and considered during matching.
Lack of documented mentorship connections	US-C05	The platform records match and supports communication with relevant participants.
Difficulty following up on mentorship progress	US-C06, US-C10	The client can manage connection statuses and review follow-up needs.
Risk of unauthorised profile access	US-C03, US-C09	Role-based access restricts profile visibility to authorised users.
Need for communication after a match	US-C05, US-M2	Proposed notifications and mentor responses support coordination; detailed workflow requires client confirmation.
Uncertainty about match status, next steps, and usefulness	US-C05, US-C06, US-S07, US-S08, US-S10, US-S11	Student-facing connection details, optional readiness response, feedback, and status visibility help the client coordinate follow-up; proposed workflows require client validation.

3.4 Research Limitations

Limitation	Explanation	Impact on the Project

Small survey sample	Twenty-one responses were received: eleven students, three mentors, and seven clients/administrator.	Findings may not represent the wider student and mentor population.
Limited client/administrator survey data	Only one client/administrator response/meeting is represented, so administrator perspectives remain limited.	Client requirements should be distinguished from survey-derived findings.
Incomplete responses	Some respondents provided no usable additional details.	Certain preferences and expectations require further investigation.
Different mentoring preferences	Respondents reported different communication methods and durations.	The platform should capture relevant requirements rather than assume one preference for everyone.
Proposed features need validation	Notifications, dashboard metrics, matching criteria, and status workflows require confirmation and testing.	Validate these features against client expectations and the user-story acceptance criteria.
Open workflow questions	Mandatory profile fields, notification channels, status values, and mentor approval requirements may need clarification.	Confirm these decisions with the client before finalising implementation.

Conclusion: The survey and client requirements informed all 21 user stories, including at least eleven student-focused stories. Together, these stories cover registration, profile maintenance, authorised client access, client-mediated matching, confidentiality, mentorship records, notifications, availability, status management, and follow-up tracking. The survey provides preliminary evidence of user's needs, while the client's instructions establish the platform's central matching and access-control workflow.

4. SMART User Stories

4.1 User Stories — Student, Mentor and Client Roles

Client requirement: students and mentors can create and maintain their own profiles. Students cannot view or browse mentor profiles, and mentors do not browse student profiles. The authorised client can access both profile types and is responsible for connecting students with suitable mentors. The stories below are aligned with this client-mediated workflow.

US-S01 — Student Registration and Profile Creation

As a student,
I want to register and create a profile with my program level, career goals, skills, and mentoring needs,
So that the client can understand my needs and consider me for a suitable mentorship match.

SMART review

Specific	Students can register and create or update their own profiles; student profiles are not visible to other students or mentors.
Measurable	Required registration fields are validated, duplicate email addresses are rejected, and a saved profile is available to the client/admin view.

Achievable	Uses standard authentication, profile forms, role-based permissions, and an administrative dashboard.
Relevant	The client-mediated model requires student information to support matching without exposing profiles directly to students.
Time-boxed	Deliver the basic registration and profile flow in a sprint agreed by the team.

Acceptance criteria

- Students can register using the agreed required fields and securely log in.
- Students can create and edit their program level, career goal, skills, and mentoring needs.
- Students cannot browse or open other students' or mentors' profiles.
- The authorised client/admin can view student profiles for matching.

Evidence / validation

Based on the client's stated requirement that students create profiles but cannot view mentor profiles; the client accesses both profile types to connect participants.

Proposed Platform Feature

Student registration, profile management, and access control

US-M01 — Mentor Registration and Profile Creation

As a mentor,
I want to register and create a profile with my subjects, skills, qualifications, experience, and mentoring availability,
So that the client can identify which students I may be able to support.

SMART review

Specific	Mentors can register and create or update a mentor profile with expertise and availability details.
Measurable	Required fields are validated; the profile is saved and appears in the authorised client/admin dashboard.
Achievable	Uses the same profile-management approach with mentor-specific fields.
Relevant	The client needs information about mentor expertise to make suitable connections.
Time-boxed	Deliver alongside student profile functionality, according to the agreed sprint plan.

Acceptance criteria

- Mentors can register and securely log in.
- Mentors can add and update subjects, skills, qualifications, experience, and availability.
- Mentors cannot browse student profiles or other mentors' profiles unless the client explicitly authorises a separate permission.
- The authorised client/admin can view mentor profiles for matching.

Evidence / validation

Derived directly from the client's stated requirement that mentors create profiles and the client can access mentor and student profiles.

Proposed Platform Feature

Mentor registration, profile management, and access control

US-C01 — Client Access to Student and Mentor Profiles

As a client/administrator,
I want to view and search student and mentor profiles from a secure dashboard,
So that I can assess suitability and connect students with appropriate mentors.

SMART review

Specific	Provide the authorised client with a single dashboard to access both student and mentor profile records.
Measurable	The client can filter profiles by agreed fields, open profile details, and only authorised client accounts can access this dashboard.
Achievable	Uses role-based access control and profile search/filter functions.
Relevant	This is the central workflow in the client-mediated mentorship model.
Time-boxed	Prioritise as a core feature after registration and profile storage are working.

Acceptance criteria

- The client can view student and mentor profiles from separate dashboard sections.
- The client can search or filter profiles using agreed fields such as subject, skill, goal, or program level.
- Unauthorised users are denied access to the dashboard and profile records.
- Profile access is restricted to the authorised client role.

Evidence / validation

Directly specified by the client: the client has access to both student and mentor profiles.

Proposed Platform Feature

Client dashboard and profile search

US-C02 — Match Students with Suitable Mentors

As a client/administrator,
I want to compare student goals and mentoring needs with mentor expertise and availability,
So that I can create relevant mentorship connections.

SMART review

Specific	Support manual matching based on student needs and mentor skills, subjects, experience, and availability.
Measurable	Each proposed match records the selected student, mentor, matching rationale, and current status.
Achievable	A manual matching workflow can be implemented without requiring an advanced recommendation algorithm.
Relevant	Matching is the defining responsibility of the client in the stated operating model.
Time-boxed	Include in the first functional version after both profile types are available.

Acceptance criteria

- The client can view student needs and mentor expertise side by side or navigate between their profiles.
- The client can select a student and a mentor and create a proposed match.
- The system records the match and its status.
- The client can see the basis for the match, such as topic/skill alignment or availability.

Evidence / validation

Directly based on the client's requirement that they will connect students and mentors.

Proposed Platform Feature

Client-led mentorship matching

US-C03 — Record and Notify a Mentorship Connection

As a client/administrator,
I want to confirm a student–mentor match and notify both participants of the connection and next steps,
So that both participants know that mentorship has been arranged and how to proceed.

SMART review

Specific	Let the client confirm a match and send notifications to the selected student and mentor.
Measurable	A confirmed match is stored with date, participants, status, and notification outcome.
Achievable	Uses a match record and an agreed notification channel, such as email or in-app messages.
Relevant	A match must be communicated clearly for the mentorship to begin.
Time-boxed	Implement after the client matching workflow; confirm the notification channel with the client.

Acceptance criteria

- The client can confirm or cancel a proposed match.
- On confirmation, the system records the student, mentor, date, and status.
- The student and mentor receive a notification containing the agreed next steps.
- If notification delivery fails, the system shows the client an appropriate status.

Evidence / validation

A proposed workflow needed to operationalise the client's stated matching responsibility; notification channel requires confirmation.

Proposed Platform Feature

Match confirmation and participant notifications

US-C04 — Manage Mentorship Status

As a client/administrator,
I want to view and update the status of each mentorship connection,
So that I can monitor whether a match is proposed, confirmed, active, completed, or cancelled.

SMART review

Specific	Provide status management for every mentorship connection.
Measurable	Each match has one status from a team-approved list, and status changes are recorded.
Achievable	Uses a status field and a client dashboard list.
Relevant	The client coordinates mentorship and needs visibility into active and completed connections.
Time-boxed	Implement with the matching workflow.

Acceptance criteria

- The client can view mentorship connections and their current status.
- The client can update status using the approved status values.
- The system saves the change and displays the latest status on the dashboard.
- Only authorised client users can change match status unless additional roles are agreed.

Evidence / validation

Inferred operational requirement from the client-led matching model; confirm the exact status values with the client.

Proposed Platform Feature

Mentorship lifecycle management

US-S02 — Update Student Profile and Mentoring Needs

As a student,
I want to update my career goals, skills, and mentoring needs when they change,
So that the client can use current information when considering or revising a match.

SMART review

Specific	Students can edit their own permitted profile fields after registration.
Measurable	Saved changes appear on the profile and are visible to the authorised client.
Achievable	Uses standard profile-edit forms and validation.
Relevant	Accurate student information supports client-led matching.
Time-boxed	Include in the initial student profile feature.

Acceptance criteria

- Students can edit the fields designated as student-editable.
- Required fields are validated before changes are saved.
- The updated profile is visible to the authorised client.
- Students still cannot browse mentor profiles or other students' profiles.

Evidence / validation

Derived from the need to maintain useful student profiles in the client-mediated matching workflow.

Proposed Platform Feature

Student profile maintenance

US-C05 — Update Mentor Expertise and Availability

As a client/administrator,
I want to update mentors' expertise, skills, experience, and availability information,
So that I can make suitable mentoring matches based on students' needs.

SMART review

Specific	The client/administrator can update permitted expertise, experience, and availability fields in mentor profiles.
Measurable	Changes are saved and reflected in the authorized client dashboard.
Achievable	Uses standard profile-management functionality.
Relevant	Up-to-date mentor information helps the client make suitable matches.
Time-boxed	Include this functionality in the initial profile-management feature.

Acceptance criteria

- The client/administrator can edit permitted mentor profile fields.
- Required fields are validated and saved.
- Updated information is visible on the authorized client dashboard.
- Only authorized users can modify mentor information.

Evidence / validation

Derived from the client's need to compare current mentor expertise with student needs.

Proposed Platform Feature

Mentor profile and availability management.

US-C06 — Protect Profile Confidentiality by Role

As a client/administrator,
I want to ensure each user can access only the profiles and functions permitted for their role,
So that student and mentor information remains confidential while the client can perform matching.

SMART review

Specific	Apply role-based permissions for students, mentors, and the authorised client.
Measurable	Access tests confirm students cannot view mentor or other student profiles, mentors cannot browse student profiles, and authorised client users can access both profile types.
Achievable	Uses authenticated roles and server-side access checks on profile pages and data endpoints.
Relevant	The client explicitly requires students not to see mentor profiles while the client can see both profile types.
Time-boxed	Build and test permissions alongside authentication and profile access.

Acceptance criteria

- Students can view and edit only their own permitted profile fields.
- Mentors can view and edit only their own permitted profile fields.
- Students cannot search, open, or retrieve mentor or other student profiles.
- Only authorised client accounts can view both student and mentor profiles.
- Access restrictions are enforced by the backend, not only by hiding interface links.

Evidence / validation

Directly reflects the client's access-control requirement.

Proposed Platform Feature

Role-based access control and profile confidentiality

US-C07 — View Matching Overview and Follow-up Needs

As a client/administrator,
I want to view a summary of student profiles, mentor profiles, proposed matches, and pending follow-ups,
So that I can coordinate the mentoring process and identify cases that need attention.

SMART review

Specific	Provide a client dashboard summary of profiles and mentorship-match statuses.
Measurable	The dashboard shows agreed counts and a list of pending actions that link to the relevant record.
Achievable	Can be built from profile and match records; advanced analytics can be deferred.
Relevant	The client is responsible for coordinating connections between students and mentors.
Time-boxed	Add a basic overview after profile and matching records are available.

Acceptance criteria

- The dashboard displays counts of student profiles, mentor profiles, and matches by status.
- The client can open pending matches or follow-ups from the summary.
- Displayed counts reflect the underlying saved records.
- Only authorised client users can access the overview.

Evidence / validation

Proposed administrative support for the client-led workflow; confirm the exact dashboard metrics with the client.

Proposed Platform Feature

Client matching overview and follow-up dashboard

US-M02 — Update and Edit Mentor Profile

As a mentor,
I want to update and edit my mentor profile, including my professional background, qualifications, skills, experience, and areas of expertise,
So that the client can use my current professional information to assess my suitability and make appropriate mentoring matches.

SMART review

Specific	Mentors can edit their professional background, qualifications, skills, experience, and areas of expertise in their profiles.
Measurable	Changes are saved, and updated profile details are visible to the authorized client
Achievable	Uses standard mentor profile-editing functionality.
Relevant	Accurate and up-to-date mentor information helps the client assess suitability and make appropriate mentoring matches.
Time-boxed	Include this functionality in the initial mentor profile-management feature.

Acceptance criteria

- Mentors can edit their professional background, qualifications, skills, experience, and areas of expertise.
- Required fields are validated before changes are saved.
- Updated information is available to the authorized client for matching.
- Students cannot browse mentor profiles directly.

Evidence / validation

Derived from the client's need to assess mentor suitability using accurate and up-to-date professional information.

Proposed Platform Feature

Mentor profile editing and updating functionality.

US-M03 — Maintain Mentorship Availability and Respond to Client Contact

As a mentor,
I want to keep my availability current and respond when the client contacts me about a potential student match,
So that the client can confirm suitable connections without relying on outdated information.

SMART review

Specific	Mentors can update availability and record their response to a client-proposed match.
Measurable	Availability changes are saved; response status is recorded for each proposed match if the client approves this workflow.
Achievable	Uses profile availability fields and a simple response action or status.
Relevant	Availability and mentor agreement can help the client coordinate suitable connections.
Time-boxed	Availability editing belongs in the initial profile release; response workflow timing depends on client confirmation.

Acceptance criteria

- Mentors can update their availability in their profile.
- The client can see the latest availability when reviewing potential matches.
- If mentor confirmation is required, the mentor can record accept/decline or request clarification.
- The system records the response and makes it visible to the authorised client.

Evidence / validation

Availability is supported by survey requests for flexible timing; mentor response workflow is a proposed detail to validate with the client.

Proposed Platform Feature

Mentor availability and optional match-response workflow

US-S03 — Define Mentorship Goals and Expected Outcomes

As a student,
I want to describe the specific goals I want to help with and the outcome I hope to achieve,
so that the client can match me with a mentor whose expertise is relevant.

SMART review

Specific	Capture mentoring goals and desired outcomes in the student profile.
Measurable	A student can save at least one goal; the client can view it in the authorized dashboard.
Achievable	Use a structured field and optional description in the existing profile form.
Relevant	Goal clarity supports suitable client-mediated matching.
Time-boxed	Include in the initial profile workflow; confirm detailed fields with the client.

Acceptance criteria

- Students can enter one or more goals and a short description of the guidance they need.
- The goal information is saved to the student profile and visible only to the authorised client/admin.
- Required fields and reasonable text limits are validated before saving.

Evidence / validation

Student respondents reported needs including skill enhancement, career switching, and resume/interview preparation. Structured goals help the client make a relevant match.

Proposed Platform Feature

Structured student goals and expected outcomes

US-S04 — Specify Preferred Mentor Expertise

As a student,
I want to identify the subject, skill, or career area where I need guidance,
so that the client can consider my needs when selecting a mentor.

SMART review

Specific	Record the student's requested subject or expertise area.
Measurable	At least one expertise area can be saved and viewed by the client.
Achievable	Use selectable categories plus an optional free-text field.
Relevant	The client uses the information to compare student needs with mentor expertise.

Time-boxed	Deliver with the initial student profile; validate the category list with the client.

Acceptance criteria

- Students can select or enter relevant skill, subject, or career areas.
- The selected areas are stored with the profile and available to the authorised client/admin.
- Students cannot search or browse mentor profiles using these preferences.

Evidence / validation

Survey responses mention skill enhancement, career switching, and the importance of topic-specific expertise and mentor credentials.

Proposed Platform Feature

Student expertise and career-area preferences

US-S05 — Choose Preferred Mentorship Format and Duration

As a student,
I want to state my preferred interaction format and approximate mentorship duration,
so that the client can consider a workable mentoring arrangement.

SMART review

Specific	Capture preferred interaction mode and expected duration.
Measurable	Both fields can be saved, edited, and displayed to the client.
Achievable	Add simple preference fields to the student profile.
Relevant	Preferences help the client coordinate a practical match.
Time-boxed	Include in the first release, subject to agreement on available options.

Acceptance criteria

- Students can select from client-approved formats, such as video call, phone, or messaging.
- Students can indicate an expected duration or choose “not sure yet”.
- Preferences are visible to the authorised client/admin only and can be updated.

Evidence / validation

Survey responses include Google Meet, phone/WhatsApp, and durations ranging from short engagements to several weeks; preferences vary.

Proposed Platform Feature

Preferred interaction format and duration

US-S06 — Share Availability for Mentorship

As a student, I want to provide my general availability,
so that the client can consider scheduling when coordinating a mentorship connection.

SMART review

Specific	Let students provide general availability.
Measurable	Availability can be saved and updated and appears in the client view.
Achievable	Use day/time preference fields without building a full calendar in the first release.

Relevant	Scheduling information can reduce coordination delays.
Time-boxed	Include basic availability fields in the initial release; validate time-zone and scheduling needs.

Acceptance criteria

- Students can enter preferred days or time windows.
- Availability can be updated after registration.
- Only the authorised client/admin can view the information for coordination.

Evidence / validation

Respondents mentioned flexible timings and different interaction preferences; detailed scheduling rules still require client confirmation.

Proposed Platform Feature

Student availability fields

US-S07 — Review a Client-Assigned Mentorship Connection

As a student,
I want to receive the details of a mentorship connection selected by the client,
so that I understand the next step without browsing mentor profiles.

SMART review

Specific	Provide a student-specific view of a client-assigned connection.
Measurable	An assigned student can see the approved match details and next step.
Achievable	Link a match record to the relevant student account and enforce permissions.
Relevant	Students need clear information once a match is made, while preserving client-led matching.
Time-boxed	Implement after the client matching workflow; confirm which mentor details may be shared.

Acceptance criteria

- The student can view only the details of a connection assigned to them and approved for sharing.
- The connection screen shows agreed information, next steps, and current status.
- The student cannot browse or search other mentors or students.

Evidence / validation

The client's operating model requires the client to review both profile types and make the match; students do not browse mentor profiles.

Proposed Platform Feature

Private student view of a client-assigned mentorship connection

US-S08 — Confirm Readiness for an Assigned Connection

As a student,
I want to confirm whether I am ready to proceed with a client-assigned mentorship connection,
so that the client can coordinate the next step.

SMART review

Specific	Provide a response action for an assigned connection if approved by the client.
Measurable	A response is recorded against the correct match and shown in the client dashboard.
Achievable	Use a small set of response states such as ready/not ready, if agreed.

Relevant	Helps the client coordinate connections and follow-up.
Time-boxed	Treat as a proposed feature until the client confirms the workflow and statuses.

Acceptance criteria

- The student can record a response to an assigned connection if the client approves this workflow.
- The response and timestamp are stored and visible to the authorised client/admin.
- No response action exposes other mentor or student profiles.

Evidence / validation

A student confirmation step may help coordination, but the client has not yet confirmed whether this is required.

Proposed Platform Feature

Optional student readiness response for an assigned connection

US-S09 — Request Help if a Match Is Not Suitable

As a student,
I want to tell the client when an assigned mentorship connection does not meet my needs,
so that the client can review the situation and decide on follow-up.

SMART review

Specific	Allow a student to flag a concern about an assigned connection.
Measurable	The concern is stored and appears in the client's follow-up list.
Achievable	Use a simple request/review form attached to the match record.
Relevant	Gives the client a controlled way to address a mismatch.
Time-boxed	Proposed for a later iteration after the client approves the rematch process.

Acceptance criteria

- The student can submit a short concern or request for review against their assigned connection, if approved.
- The request is visible to the authorised client/admin and linked to the correct match.
- The platform does not automatically assign a different mentor; any rematch remains client-controlled.

Evidence / validation

Respondents reported matching difficulties and concerns about finding relevant guidance. A rematch process needs client confirmation.

Proposed Platform Feature

Student concern/request-for-review workflow

US-S10 — Provide Feedback on Mentorship

As a student,
I want to provide feedback after a mentorship interaction or engagement,
so that the client can understand whether the support was useful and identify follow-up needs.

SMART review

Specific	Capture feedback about the student's own mentorship experience.
Measurable	Feedback can be submitted and linked to a match record.
Achievable	Use a short rating and optional comment field if approved.
Relevant	Feedback can help the client improve coordination and identify issues.
Time-boxed	Validate feedback fields, privacy, and timing with the client before implementation.

Acceptance criteria

- The student can submit feedback only for their own assigned mentorship connection.
- Feedback is stored securely and visible only to authorised personnel as agreed.
- The platform does not expose feedback to other students or unrelated mentors.

Evidence / validation

Research points to varied mentoring needs and the importance of useful, relevant guidance; the timing and visibility of feedback need confirmation.

Proposed Platform Feature

Private mentorship feedback form

US-S11 — Track Mentorship Progress and Next Steps

As a student,
I want to see the agreed status and next step for my assigned mentorship connection,
so that I know whether I should wait, prepare, or follow up.

SMART review

Specific	Show status and agreed next steps for the student's assigned connection.
Measurable	The student view reflects the latest saved status and next-step text.
Achievable	Display selected fields from the existing match record.
Relevant	Clear status information can reduce uncertainty and repeated follow-up.
Time-boxed	Implement with match-status management after the client approves student-visible statuses.

Acceptance criteria

- The student sees the current status and next step for their own connection only.
- The information is updated when the authorised client changes the match status.
- The student cannot change administrative match status or view unrelated records.

Evidence / validation

The project's client-mediated workflow includes tracking connection status; students also need clarity about what happens next.

Proposed Platform Feature

Student-facing connection status and next steps

5. Requirements Clarification and Interpretation

Based on the common end-user discussion and the team's understanding of the mentoring requirements, the following key points have been identified. These interpretations guide the proposed platform's features, access controls, and mentorship workflow.

5.1 Personalized Mentor Matching

Requirement clarification: Students need mentoring support based on their academic background, career goals, professional interests, and specific challenges, such as resume preparation, interview readiness, or startup guidance.

Team's interpretation: A general mentoring arrangement may not address every student's individual needs. Effective matching should consider the student's profile, expectations, and the mentor's expertise and availability.

Influence on the proposed solution: The platform will collect relevant information through student and mentor profiles. The authorized client or administrator will review these profiles and connect suitable students with mentors. Students will not directly browse mentor profiles or independently select mentors.

5.2 Structured Mentorship Goals and Outcomes

Requirement clarification: Students require practical, goal-oriented guidance rather than generic advice. Mentoring may focus on specific outcomes, such as improving a resume, preparing for interviews, exploring career opportunities, or developing a startup idea.

Team's interpretation: Mentorship should have clearly defined objectives and expected outcomes so that both participants understand the purpose of the engagement and can assess progress.

Influence on the proposed solution: The platform will support the definition of mentorship goals, expected outcomes, and progress tracking. These features will help students and mentors maintain focus throughout the mentoring period.

5.3 Flexible Communication and Availability

Requirement clarification: Students and mentors may have different schedules and may prefer different communication methods, including chat, video calls, or asynchronous question-and-answer interactions.

Team's interpretation: The platform should accommodate different schedules and communication preferences instead of assuming that every mentoring interaction will take place through scheduled meetings.

Influence on the proposed solution: The proposed platform will capture availability and support communication preferences, notifications, and coordination of mentoring interactions. The precise communication and scheduling features will depend on the final scope of implementation.

5.4 Privacy and Controlled Access to Profiles

Requirement clarification: Users expect their academic, professional, and personal information to be handled appropriately. There is also a concern that mentoring responses may be too generic to address individual needs.

Team's interpretation: Profile information should be accessible only to authorised users for legitimate mentoring purposes. At the same time, the matching process should use sufficient information to identify suitable mentor-student combinations.

Influence on the proposed solution: The platform will follow a client-mediated matching model. Students and mentors will submit their profiles, while the authorised client or administrator will access the relevant information and facilitate matching. Access to profile information will be controlled according to user roles.

5.5 Defined Mentorship Duration and Status

Requirement clarification: Mentorship engagements may continue for a limited period, with the discussion indicating that a typical duration could be around one to three months.

Team's interpretation: Mentorship should be treated as a managed engagement with a defined status, rather than as an indefinite connection without follow-up.

Influence on the proposed solution: The platform will support mentorship-status tracking and help monitor whether an engagement is active, completed, or otherwise requires an update. The actual duration will be determined by the participants and the applicable program requirements.

6. Assumptions and Open Questions

The proposed solution is based on the following assumptions and unresolved questions. These will need further clarification during subsequent requirements analysis and implementation.

A. Assumptions

1. **Primary user group:** Current IITM BS students and IITM alumni (mentors) are the primary users of the platform, platform administrators, IIC team form the secondary user group. While employers and industry contacts, faculty, teaching assistants, the IITM BS Program office form the tertiary user group.
2. **Client-mediated matching:** Students and mentors will create and maintain their profiles, but students will not directly browse mentor profiles. An authorized client or administrator will review the profiles and facilitate matching.
3. **Profile-based recommendations:** Student interests, academic background, career goals, mentor expertise, and availability will be relevant factors in determining suitable matches.
4. **Voluntary participation:** Students and mentors are assumed to participate willingly and provide accurate information in their profiles.
5. **Goal-oriented mentoring:** Each mentorship engagement is expected to have defined goals or expected outcomes, which can be used to guide discussions and monitor progress.

6. **Flexible interaction:** Different participants may have different communication preferences and schedules. The platform should therefore accommodate flexibility wherever supported by the final implementation.
7. **Limited-duration engagements:** A mentoring period of approximately one to three months is considered a possible reference point based on the end-user discussion, not a mandatory duration for every engagement.

B. Ambiguities and Edge Cases

1. **Insufficient matching information:** A student or mentor may provide incomplete profile details, making it difficult to identify an appropriate match.
2. **No suitable mentor available:** A student's requirements may not align with the expertise or availability of any currently available mentor.
3. **Multiple suitable matches:** More than one mentor may be suitable for a student. The criteria for prioritizing one match over another need to be defined.
4. **Change in goals:** A student's academic or career priorities may change after mentorship begins, requiring the goals or matching arrangement to be reviewed.
5. **Inactive participants:** A student or mentor may stop responding or become unavailable during an active mentorship engagement.
6. **Confidentiality and access:** The extent to which profile information, conversations, and progress records can be viewed by administrators or other authorized personnel requires clarification.
7. **Mentorship completion or termination:** The process for extending, completing, discontinuing, or rematching an engagement needs to be established.

C. Open Questions

1. **Matching responsibility:** Will matching be performed entirely by the client or administrator, or will the platform also provide recommendations to assist the matching process?
2. **Matching criteria and priorities:** What minimum information must be collected from students and mentors, and how should expertise, interests, availability, and student preferences be prioritized?
3. **Mentor capacity:** How many students can a mentor support simultaneously, and how will the platform handle mentors who reach their capacity?
4. **Communication implementation:** Will chat and video communication be built into the platform, or will the platform coordinate interactions through external communication tools?
5. **Notifications and reminders:** Which events should trigger notifications, and which channels should be used to deliver them?
6. **Privacy and retention:** What consent mechanisms, access permissions, and data-retention rules should apply to profile information and mentorship records?

7. **Progress evaluation:** How will mentoring outcomes be evaluated? Will the platform include feedback forms, progress reviews, or completion assessments?
8. **Handling unsuccessful matches:** What procedure should be followed when a match does not work, a participant withdraws, or is there no suitable mentor available?
9. **Duration and extensions:** Will the one-to-three-month period be a guideline, a default duration, or a formal program requirement? Who can approve an extension?
10. **Administrative roles:** Which administrative actions can the client perform, and will different levels of access be required for program coordinators and platform administrators?

These assumptions and open questions will serve as a basis for further discussion with stakeholders. Clarifying them will help the team refine the requirements, establish implementation priorities, and ensure that the proposed platform remains aligned with end-user needs.

7. Summary

The user stories have been revised to reflect a client-mediated mentorship model. The core workflow is student and mentor registration → profile creation and maintenance → client reviews both profiles → client matches a student with a mentor → the match is recorded and communicated → the client tracks its status.